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Introduction to Management

MGNT110

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Managing Knowledge and Learning

Lecture 8



Learning Objectives

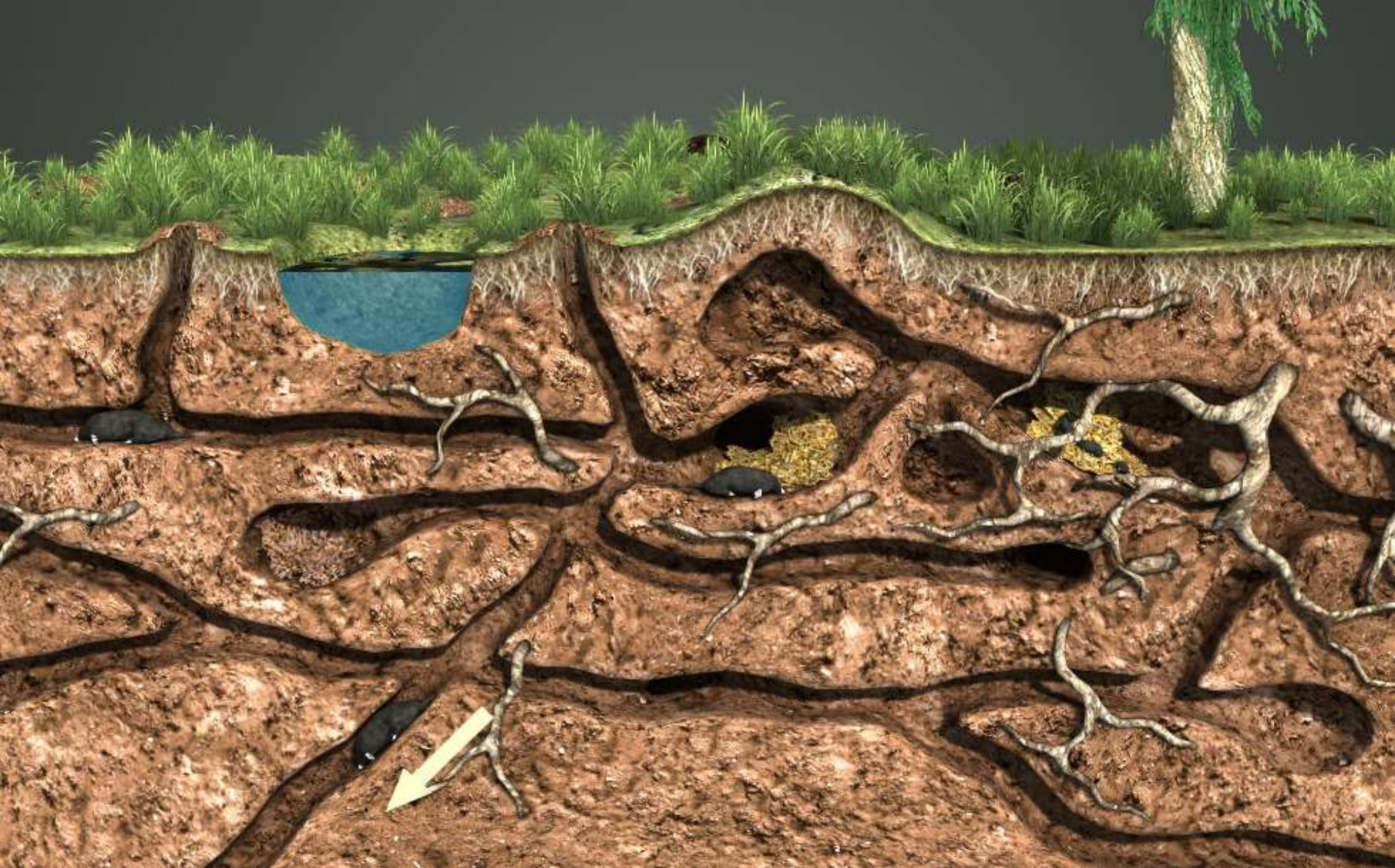
- Understanding the types of knowledge
- Importance of learning
- Explorative and exploitative lenses
- Organisational learning



Importance of knowledge



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Types of Knowledge

Explicit Knowledge	Tacit Knowledge
The knowledge we conscious talk about	Focal Awareness and Subsidiary awareness
Requires reflection	often based on experience
Often documented or recorded	Embodied, intuitive and often unconscious
Visible, structured and shareable	e.g. background details or tools (like feeling a hammer's grip) while one's main attention (focal awareness) is aimed at a target (driving a nail).



We know more than we can tell

- This classic idea explains tacit knowledge very well. People often know how to do things without being able to fully explain every step. A highly skilled worker may perform excellently but struggle to describe exactly how they do it. That shows why knowledge management is challenging: not all valuable knowledge can simply be captured in a file.

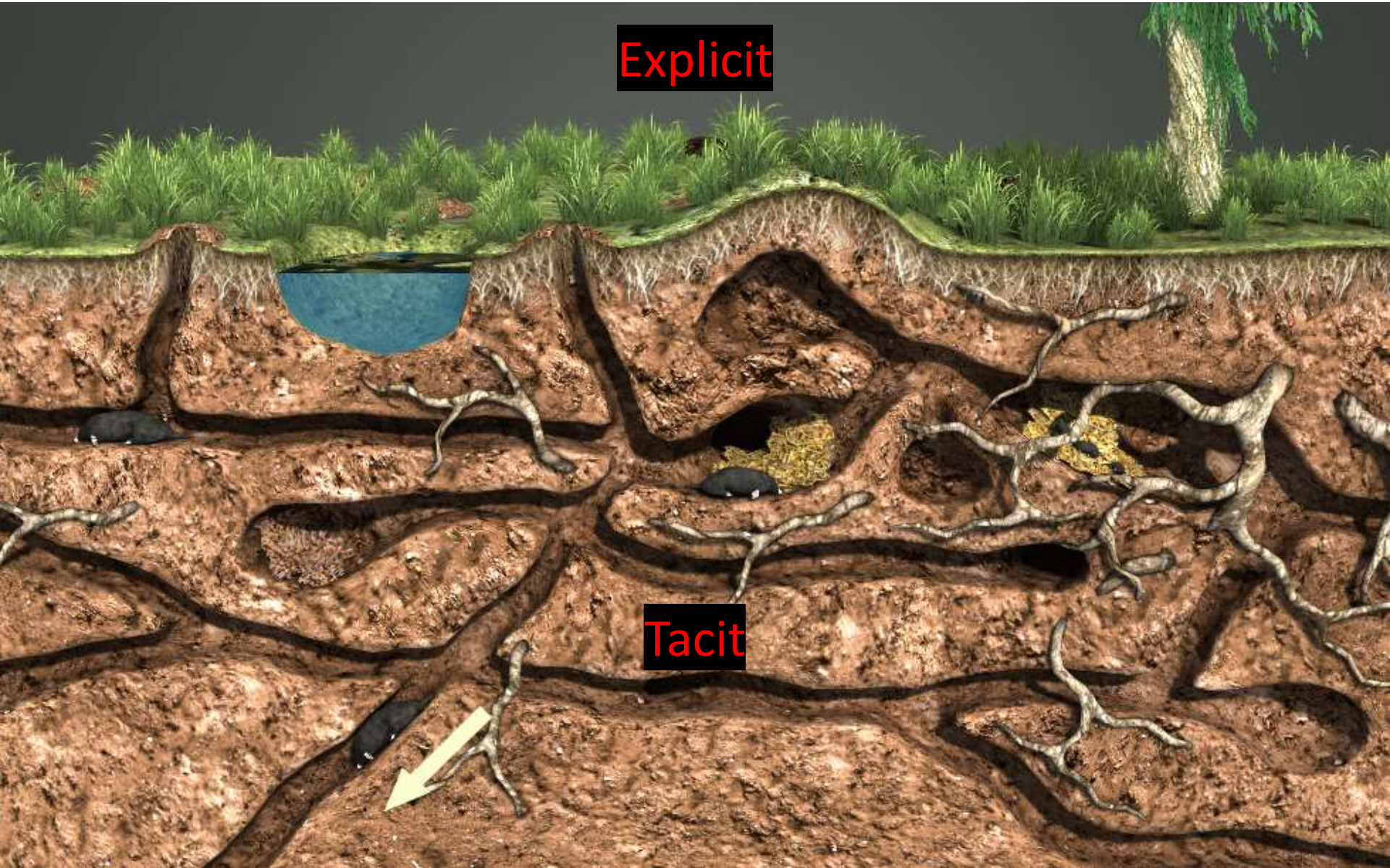


- “Life underground is much deeper and more profound than life above ground. The roots of large trees, for instance, cover an area that is almost as large as the part of the tree above ground. People think that what is visible to them is truth, but things are connected in all sorts of ways...”

- Shio Chiharu, *In the Earth*, 2012

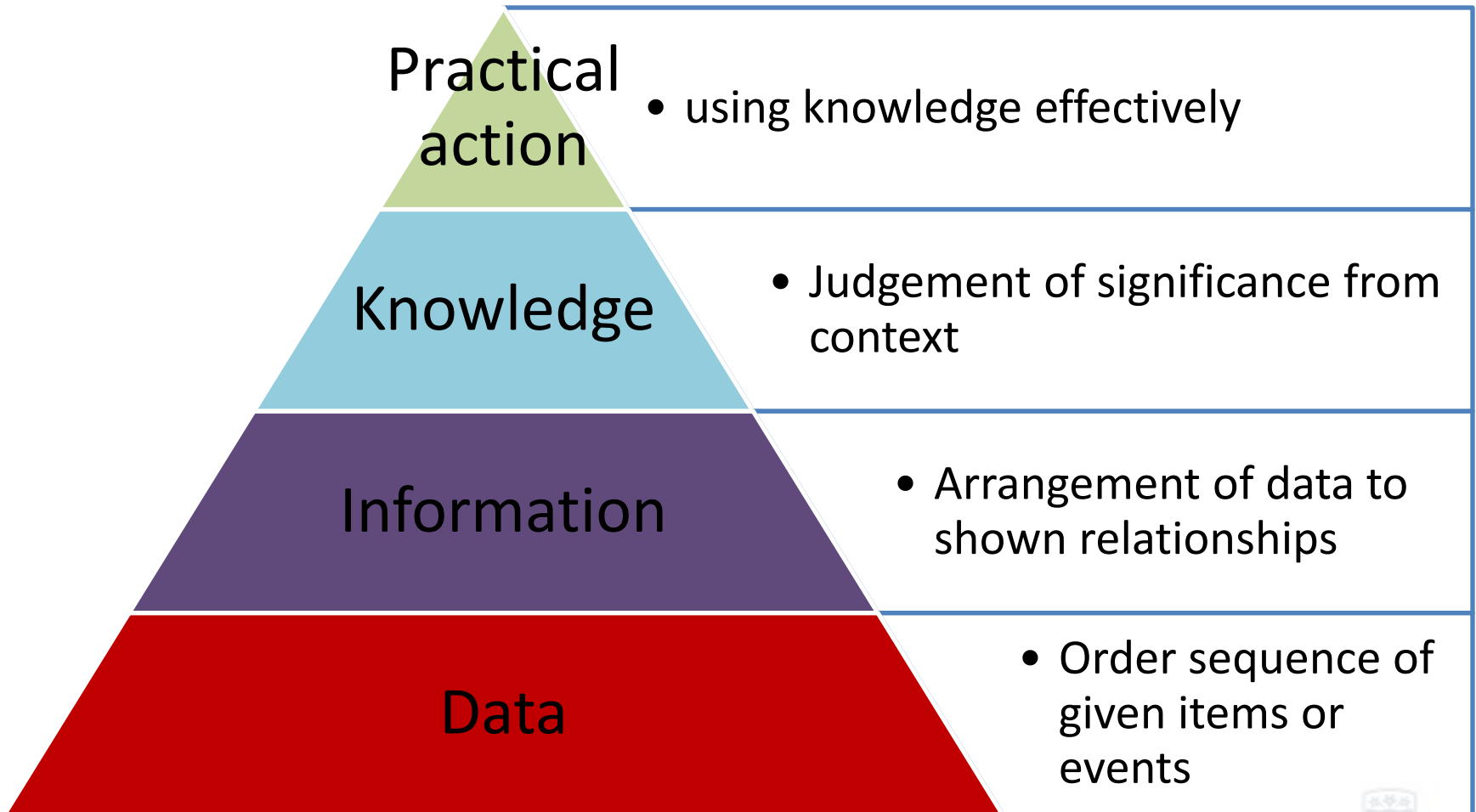
Types Knowledge

Explicit



Tacit

Tsoukas and Vladimirov 2002



Why learning matters in organisations



Rogers (1969)

- “We are, in my view, faced with an entirely new situation in education where the goal of education, if we are to survive, is the *facilitation of change and learning*. The only man (sic) who is educated is **the man who has learned how to learn; the man who has learned how to adapt and change; the man who has realised that no knowledge is secure, that only the process of seeking knowledge gives a basis for security**. Changingness, a reliance on process rather than upon static knowledge, is the only thing that makes sense as a goal for education in the modern world.”



What is learning?

- “...We are thus the **learning** species, and our survival depends on our ability to adapt not only in the reactive sense of fitting into the **physical and social worlds**, but in the **proactive** sense of creating and shaping those worlds.”



David Kolb, image courtesy of <https://sonria.com/glossary/david-kolb/>

Summary

- learning: is a process, not just memorising,
- requires self-awareness and responsiveness,
- is driven by adaptation,
- and is fundamental to organisational success.
- That is an important bridge to the next part: not all learning is the same. Some learning improves existing systems, while other learning creates new possibilities.

Break Time



Learning through adaptation

EXPLORATIVE AND EXPLOITATIVE LEARNING

Exploitation

What is known



Exploration

What might come to be known



March, JG 1995, 'The future, disposable organizations and the rigidities of imagination', *Organization: The Interdisciplinary Journal of Organization, Theory and Society*, vol. 2, no. 3-4, pp. 427-40.



Explorative and Exploitative Learning

Exploitation

Improving and refining what the organisation already knows.

Focus:

- efficiency
- improvement
- repetition
- Refinement

Exploration

Experimenting, innovating, taking risks, and trying new approaches.

Focus:

- innovation
- experimentation
- risk-taking
- Discovery



Vs



The SpaceX example reflects exploration because it involves experimentation, uncertainty, and breakthrough innovation.

Explorative and Exploitative Learning

Exploitation

Improving and refining what the organisation already knows.

Focus:

- efficiency

James G. March (1995):
Organisations need to strike a balance between exploitation (improving efficiency and refining existing capabilities) and exploration (pursuing innovation and new opportunities).

Exploration

Experimenting, innovating, taking risks, and trying new approaches.

Focus:

- innovation
- experimentation
- risk-taking
- Discovery



The SpaceX example reflects exploration because it involves experimentation, uncertainty, and breakthrough innovation.

Learning in Netflix

- Netflix started in 1997 as a DVD rental-by-mail service in the United States.
- Customers received DVDs in a red envelope, watched them, and returned them using the same envelope.
- No late fees



Learning in Netflix

Exploitation

- DVD delivery system
 - improved existing system
- logistics optimisation
 - focused on efficiency
- subscription model
 - reduced costs
- faster service
 - improved customer convenience



Learning in Netflix

Exploration

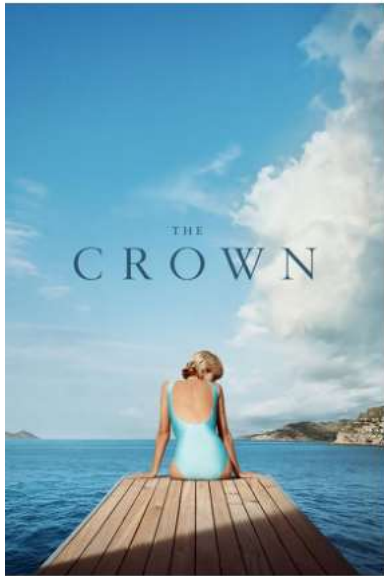
- moved away from DVDs
 - new technology
 - uncertain demand
 - high investment
 - high risk
-
- At that time (2007):
 - internet was slow
 - streaming was not proven



- Exploration = taking risks to create the future.

Case study: Learning in Netflix

EXPLORATIVE AND EXPLOITATIVE LEARNING



<https://about.netflix.com/en>



- Solved customer frustrations
- Used technology and logistics creatively
- Set the foundation for today's streaming empire

Five Stage Phenomenological Model for Skill Acquisition

NOVICE

Facilitator deconstructs process or knowledge into steps and the learner is provided rules to learn.

ADVANCED BEGINNER

Experience provides contextual examples, facilitator provides supplementary facts.

COMPETENCE

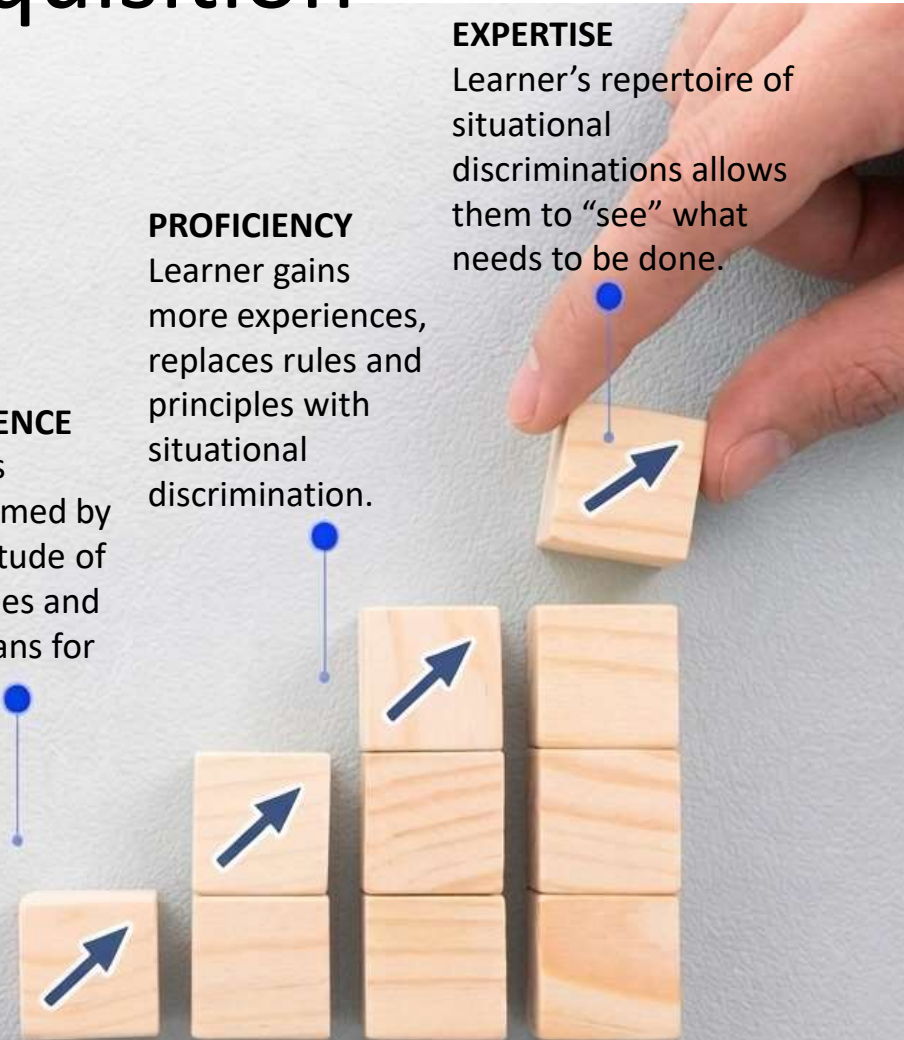
Learner is overwhelmed by the multitude of possibilities and makes plans for action.

PROFICIENCY

Learner gains more experiences, replaces rules and principles with situational discrimination.

EXPERTISE

Learner's repertoire of situational discriminations allows them to "see" what needs to be done.



Five Stage Phenomenological Model for Skill Acquisition



NOVICE

Facilitator deconstructs process or knowledge into steps and the learner is provided rules to learn.



1. Facilitator plays a key role in the novice's learning
2. The learner is provided rules and principles
3. The learner applies the rules and principles
4. Following rules and principles can still lead to poor performance

Five Stage Phenomenological Model for Skill Acquisition



ADVANCED BEGINNER

Experience provides contextual examples, facilitator provides supplementary facts.



- Learner gains new experiences with real situations
- Develops an understanding of the relevant context
- Learner or facilitator notes additional information related to the situation or domain
- Learner starts to recognise these new situations/domains
- New *maxims* are learned; these relate to the situational aspects
- Non-situational *features* are also identified and used
- Learning remains detached and analytic

Five Stage Phenomenological Model for Skill Acquisition



COMPETENCE

Learner is overwhelmed by the multitude of possibilities and makes plans for action.



- Greater experience brings more uncertainty and exhaustion
- The learner lacks the ability to know which rules, principles and maxims to apply to the multitude of possible situations
- To cope, the learner will devise a plan or choose a perspective, making learning easier
- Use rules and maxims to decide on the plan or perspective, to avoid mistakes
- Learners need to decide themselves what plan or perspective to apply to each situation
- Learning is no longer a detached experience; involvement is critical to learning

Five Stage Phenomenological Model for Skill Acquisition



PROFICIENCY

Learner gains more experiences, replaces rules and principles with situational discrimination.



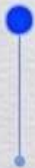
- Advancement to proficiency is possible if the learner becomes *involved*
- *Situational discrimination* will begin to replace rules and maxims, but not fully
- Learner intuitively sees the issue and important aspects of the situation
- Decisions become more atheoretical and intuitive (less “reasoned” but still deciding consciously what to do)
- Action becomes easier and less stressful

Five Stage Phenomenological Model for Skill Acquisition



EXPERTISE

Learner's repertoire of situational discriminations allows them to "see" what needs to be done.



- Immediately understands the situation and knows intuitively what needs to be done
- Able to make subtle and refined discriminations
- Capable of making immediate and intuitive situational responses
- The expert generally can't articulate how they came to a decision because they know what to do intuitively!

Role of Reflection for the Expert



- Critical reflection is required for the expert to retain their expertise.
- “*Deliberative rationality* is detached, reasoned observation of one’s intuitive, practice-based behavior with an eye to challenging, and perhaps improving, intuition without replacing it by the purely theory-based action of the novice, advanced beginner or competent performer.”

(Dreyfus & Dreyfus, 2005).

Relevance to organisational learning

- Manager has a role to play in:
 - Encouraging learners to become emotionally involved with the learning program
 - Allowing learners to voice ideas and objections, and challenge the facilitator
 - Sharing their own successes and failures
 - Observation and imitation of the expert can support other learners

Key Takeaway

- Knowledge is more than information
 - Explicit knowledge
 - Tacit knowledge
- Learning = adaptation, not memorisation
- Two types of organisational learning
 - Exploitation (Efficiency)
 - Exploration (Innovation)
- Skill Acquisition (Dreyfus Model)
- Reflection is essential for experts
- Role of Managers in Learning



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